

Bentresh Stela (Louvre C 284)

Notes by Minh-Tâm Trinh

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Glossing Conventions

(May not match the conventions in my older notes)

()	text omitted by the scribe, but implicitly understood
< >	addition to fix a scribal error
{ }	deletion to fix a scribal error
[]	addition to fix lacuna, or addition uncertain

References

[C 284] Stèle de Bakhtan [CM 463 ; BN 50 ; E 13481 ; C 284]. Département des Antiquités égyptiennes. Louvre site des collections.
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[G] A. Gardiner. *Egyptian Grammar: Being an Introduction to the Study of Hieroglyphs*. 3rd Edition, Revised. Griffith Institute, Ashmolean Museum, Oxford. Printed at the University Press, Cambridge (2007).

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[L] III. Two Pseudepigrapha: The Bentresh Stela. In *Ancient Egyptian Literature, Vol. III: The Late Period*. Trans. M. Lichtheim. University of California Press. Berkeley (1980). 90–93.

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[TLA] Thesaurus Linguae Aegyptiae. Version 2.2.0. Union of the German Academies of Sciences and Humanities. <https://tla.digital/home>

11/17/25

(1) *Hr K3 Nht*
tw t h^c.w
dd ns.y(t) mi (I)tm

Hr Nb w
ws(r) hpšw dr Pdt 9

Nsw Bity Nb T3.wy
Wsr-M^c3.t-R^c Stp-(n)-R^c

S3 R^c
ht=f Mri-Imn R^c-ms-s(w)

Imn-R^c (2) Nb Nsw.t Psd.t Nb.wt W3s.t
mri ntr nfr Imn
ms.[tī]w R^c-Hr-3h.ty
pr.w h n Nb Dr.(t)
wtt n K3-Mwt=f
nsw.t n Km.t hk3 Dšr.wt
ity (3) it Pdt 9
pri m ht
sr(w) n=f nh.tw
wd n=f pri c m swh.t

(1) Horus, Mighty Bull,
 perfect [F 295] of appearance [F 185] [*nfr hr*],
 enduring of kingship [*nfr hr*], like Atum,

Golden Horus,
 strong [F 68] of arm [*nfr hr*] [who] drives away the Nine Bows [*pd.t psd.t*],

Dual King, Lord of the Two Lands,
 Usermaatre Setepenre,

Son of Re,
 his presence [F 200], Meriamun Rameses,

Amun-Re, (2) Lord of the Thrones [*cf.* G 627 and TLA 26200] [of] the Ennead, of the
 Ladies of Thebes¹,
 beloved of the good god, Amun,
 bo[r]n of Re-Horakhty,
 seed [F 91] of the *akh* of the Lord of Ancestors[? F 324],
 begotten of Kamutef,
 king of the Black Land², ruler of the Red Land³,

1 *W3s.t* = Waset = “The Scepter”.

2 *Km.t* = Kemet.

3 *Dšr.wt* = Deshrut.

sovereign **(3)** [who] seized the Nine Bows,
that when he came forth from the womb [second tense?],
victories [F 139] were foretold [passive] [F 235] of him,
command [F 73–74] [given] to him [while] active [F 91] in the egg,

12/7/25

k3 mn ib hb=f mtwn
nsw.t n ntr pri nh.t mi Mnt(w)
wr ph.ty (4) mi s3 Nw.t

is hm=f m Nhrn mi n(y)t-^c=f tnw rnp.t
wr.w n h3s.t nb iw<=sn> m ks.w m htp.w n b3.w n hm=f š3^c <r> phw.w

Bull firm [F 106] of heart [*nfr hr*], when he trots [circumstantial?] [F 158] [into] the arena [variant spelling, F 121],
divine king [indirect genitive] [who] came [no gemination, so perfect participle] [in] might like Montu,
Great of strength [playful spelling of dual -ty] [leopard heads?] [*nfr hr*] **(4)** like the son of Nut:

So, his majesty [was] in Naharina like [that] of his custom [*cf.* H 248] each [F 305] year.
[As for] the princes of every foreign land [F 185], they came in prostrations [F 287], in peace [“peaces”], to the might [*b3.w* = mass noun?] of his majesty, as far as the far north [F 92, last variant spelling].

12/21/25

inw=sn nbw hsb(5) mfk3.t h3.w nb t3-ntr hr psd=sn
w^c nb hr hrp snw=f
h^c rdi{.t} p3 wr n Bhtn in.tw in.w=f
di.n=f s3.t=f wr.t h3t ir.w[?]
hr sw3š{y} hm=f
hr dbh [nh] hr=f
wn (6) st nfr(.ti?) r 3 wr hr ib hm=f r ht nb

[As for] their tribute [F 22]: gold, lapis lazuli, **(5)** turquoise [F 106], every herb [F 183] from the gods’ land [were] upon their back[s].
Each one was outdoing [F 196, “getting ahead of”] his companion.
Then the chief of Bakhtan caused that his tribute be brought.
[and] put his eldest daughter in front of [?],
[and] was praising [F 216] his majesty,
[and] was pleading [F 311] [for] [life] from [“upon”] him.

[*wn* as imperfect converter? TLA 550129] The **(6)** woman had been pleasing [stative?] to the utmost greatness upon his majesty's heart, than any thing [else].

1/4/26

ḥ^c.n wdn(.w) nhb(.t)=s Nsw.t Wr.t Nfr.w-R^c
 spr ḥm=f r Km.t
 ir.n=s irty nb ḥm.t-nsw

hpr ḥsb.t 15 šmw (2) sw 22
 isk ḥm=f m W3s.t Nh.t Hm.t Niw.wt
 hr ir{y}<.t> **(7)** ḥs(ty) n (i)t=f Imn-R^c Nb Nsw.t T3.wy
 m hb=f nfr n Ip(.t) s.t ib=f nt sp tp
 ii.tw r dd n ḥm=f
 wn wp.(wt) ii.n p3 wr n Bhtn iw hr in.w ṣš(3){t} n nsw.t

Then her titulary [F 138] was recorded [F 73] [past passive]: Great Queen Neferure.
 As the king returned [second tense?] to the Black Land,
 so she did every doing [which noun form?] of a king's wife [direct genitive].

It happened in regnal year 15, month 2 [playful spelling], day 22,
 lo ["non-enclitic" particle, TLA 31760; see also F 30], his majesty [was] in Mighty
 Thebes, Wife of the Cities,
 [and] was doing **(7)** the rites [F 177] for his father [*f* for both *it* and =*f*?], Amun-Re,
 Lord of Thrones of the Two Lands [TLA 26200],
 in his fine feast of Luxor⁴ [F 16], his heart's place [direct genitive] since ["from"] the
 beginning of time ["foremost time"],
 [when] one came to say to his majesty:
 There was [imperfect converter] a messenger [F 17, 60] of the chief of Bakhtan that
 came, with[?] numerous [F 49] presents have come for the queen.

1/18/26

ḥ^c.n ms(.w)[?]=f **(8)** m-b3ḥ ḥm=f ḥn^c in.w=f
 dd=f m sw3š ḥm=f
 iw n=k R^c n Pdt 9 imi nn ḥnh hr=k
 ḥ^c.n dd=f sn-t3 m-b3ḥ ḥm=f whm=f dd hr ḥm=f
 ii=i n=k it- **(9)** -y nb hr Bntrš snw.t kt n ḥm.t-nsw Nfr.w-R^c
 mn 3bḥ(.w) m ḥ^cw=s

Then he was brought [F 116] **(8)** before ["into the potency of"] [F 77–78] his majesty,
 with his gifts,
 [and] he said, in praising [F 216] his majesty,

4 *Ip(.t)* = Ipet = "The Adyton".

Hail to you, Re of the Nine Bows! Give us life from you!
 Then he spoke [tribute], kissing the earth [TLA 888530] [typo for *t3* in De Buck?]
 before his majesty, [and] he continued, saying to his majesty:
 I have come to you, sovereign, lord, on [account of] Bentresh, the younger [“other”]
 daughter of the king’s wife Neferure.
 Illness has seized [F 2] her body.

2/1/26

im{t}[?] wd hm=k rh-(i)h.t r m3=s
h^c dd.n hm=f
in n=i tt(iw) nt pr-^cnh knb.(w)t (10) nt tnw
st3.n=f hr-^c(wy)
dd hm=f
mt(n) rti (tw) s^c{t}.tw n {t}<t>n r sdm=tn mdw tn
isk in n=i hmw.t m ib=f s^cm db^cw=f m k(3)b=tn
ii pw <ir> n s^c (11) nsw tn Dhwti-m-Hb m-b3h hm=f
wd.n hm=f smy=f r Bhtn hn^c wp.(wt) pn
spr pw ir n rh-(i)h.t r Bhtn
gm.n=f Bntrš m shr hr h.yw

O [that] your majesty [would] command a wise man [missing determinative? F 151]
 to inspect [F 100] her.

Then his majesty spoke:

Bring to me the staff [TLA 177470] of the temple [“house of life”], the councils [F 280] (10) of the residence.

They were ushered in [F 255] immediately [F 175].

Spoke his majesty:

Look, it was caused that you were summoned [F 48] to this, in order that you hear
 [prospective] these words.

Now, bring to me a craftsman [F 170] in his heart, a scribe in his fingers, [from]
 within your midst [F 275].

There was a coming by a royal (11) scribe, this Thothemheb [hb on F 167], before his
 majesty.

His majesty commanded that he go forth to Bakhtan with this messenger.

There was an arrival by this wise man to Bakhtan,

[where] he found Bentresh in the state [F 242–243] of [being] upon spirits [F 4],

4/19/26

gm.n=f (12) sw hry n h3 hn^c=f
wn wr n Bhtn wh[m=f h(3)b m-b3h] hm=f m dd
ity nb=i im wd. {tw} hm=f rdi in.tw ntr[...]

(13) r hm=f n rnp.t sp 26 3bd (1) smw sw ifd hb Imn
 iw hm=f m W3s.t

[where] he found **(12)** him[self] an enemy [F 195] [L 370, 372] for fight[ing] with him.

There was [imperfect converter] a chief of Bakhtan that [“he”] relayed the message in the presence of his majesty, saying:

Sovereign, my lord, may your majesty command to cause to be brought a god[...]

(13) [to] his majesty in year 26, the first month of summer,⁵ day four [of] the festival of Amun,
while his majesty was in Thebes:

5/3/26

*ḥḥ.n whm.n ḥm=f m-b(3ḥ) Hnsw-m-W3s.t Nfr-ḥ[tp] m-dd
p3 nb nfr ir=i whm m-b(3ḥ)=k ḥr s3.t n p3 wr n Bḥ- **(14)** -tn
ḥḥ.n st3.n Hnsw-m-W3s.t Nfr-ḥtp r Hnsw-p3-ir-sḥr ntr ʿ3 sḥr(i) šm3.w
ḥḥ.n dd.n ḥm=f m-b(3ḥ) Hnsw-m-W3s.t Nfr-ḥtp*

Then his majesty relayed in the presence of Khonsu-of-Thebes Neferhotep, saying:
The good lord, I make a report in your presence about [“upon”] [the] daughter of the chief of Bakh- **(14)** -tan.

Then Khonsu-of-Thebes Neferhotep brought [“pulled”] [F 255, cf. 253] to Khonsu-the-Provider, great god that dispels [F 238] disease-demons.

Then his majesty said, in the presence of Khonsu-of-Thebes Neferhotep:

5/17/26

p3 nb nfr iw ir ʿ=k

The good lord,

⁵ *šmw* = Shemu = “Harvest”.